INDEPENDENT COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE WORK SAMPLE

Conversational AI in Life Sciences

Competitive landscape and implications for Optum Life Sciences

An outside-in assessment of publicly marketed conversational AI offerings

---

Prepared by Joseph Marino

October 2026 · Public sources reviewed as of October 13, 2026

linkedin.com/in/joseph-marino-995651183 · marinojoe@gmail.com

Independent work sample based solely on publicly available information. Not affiliated with, commissioned by or endorsed by Optum or UnitedHealth Group.
Research and drafting were assisted by AI tools; the analysis and conclusions are the author's own.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Competitors' conversational AI points to four choices for any Optum LS offering

FOUR CHOICES

WHERE IT SITS

Before purchase, in place of analyst requests, or inside the rep's CRM

Seen in: Truven, Flatiron, Verana, IQVIA

HOW IT SHOWS ITS WORK

Sources and assumptions kept visible; limits published

Seen in: EVERSANA, IQVIA

HOW MUCH AUTONOMY

Highest in RWE analysis; narrower in medical and regulatory work

Seen in: Flatiron, Verana, ZS, Veeva

BUILT OR PARTNERED

LLM providers supply competitors and sell their own products

Seen in: Anthropic, OpenAI, Cohere

KEY FINDINGS

19 **conversational AI offerings**, marketed by **15 of 43 U.S. competitors**

9 **of 34 RWE competitors** market one, the highest share of any domain

OPTUM LS POSITIONING

Optum LS publicly emphasizes linked healthcare data, AI-enabled research tools and scientific expertise.

Several competitors lead with conversational AI for comparable tasks.

This analysis assumes Optum LS is developing or evaluating its own.

WHAT COUNTS AS CONVERSATIONAL AI?

A publicly marketed interface that lets life-sciences customers use natural language to interact with data, research or business workflows. Exclude patient-facing chatbots, clinician scribes and AI without a natural-language interface.

RESEARCH SCOPE

Competitor products were sorted by customer task rather than by vendor, to match each with a specific Optum LS offering.

Those tasks were then grouped into five domains where both Optum LS and its competitors publicly market products:

RWE | Commercial Intelligence | Medical / Regulatory Research | Clinical Trials and Market Access

RESEARCH CATALYST

Seven RWE AI launches since 2024 warrant a wider look across life sciences

SELECTED PUBLIC PRODUCT ANNOUNCEMENTS

2024

Precedents

Tempus's **Tempus One / Lens** — AI-assisted research and cohort exploration (February)

Komodo Health's **MapAI** — conversational healthcare analytics (September)

August 2025

Platform expansion

Komodo Health's **Marmot** — AI-powered healthcare analytics and research workflows

April–May 2026

Research-interface launches

Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence** — natural-language RWE research questions

Flatiron Health's **Telescope** — conversational oncology cohort exploration

September 2026

New releases

Verana Health's **Agent Claire** — conversational specialty-data research

Norstella's **Atlas Patient Analytics** — agentic, managed cohort analytics

THE BROADER COMPETITIVE QUESTIONS

Where else are life sciences vendors marketing conversational AI; what tasks does it serve; and how does that positioning inform potential Optum LS offerings?

RESEARCH APPROACH

This study examines publicly-marketed conversational AI across five business domains. Vendors' product claims provide observable evidence for competitive positioning without access to internal product data.

U.S. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Conversational AI is most visible in RWE, where competitors market new access points to tasks Optum LS already serves

DOMAIN	WHO'S COMPETING	WHAT THEY PITCH	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
RWE (most active)	Komodo, Truveta, Flatiron, Tempus, HealthVerity, Norstella, Truven, ConcertAI, Verana	Pre-sale data previews; self-service analysis; packaged studies	Analytics on Demand; epidemiology research
Commercial Intelligence	IQVIA, ZS, Trinity	AI inside the rep's CRM; simulated stakeholders	Market Clarity: portfolio and patient/prescriber analytics
Medical / Regulatory Research	IQVIA, ZS, Veeva	Narrowly scoped tools; published limits	Postapproval safety studies; Market Clarity medical affairs insights
Clinical Trials (one entrant)	TriNetX	Site selection, not just patient counts	Prospector; Digital Research Network; True Source
Market Access (one entrant)	EVERSANA	Moving past chat answers	HEOR/value evidence; Evidence Engine

Scope note: Offerings are organized by their primary domain; supporting data and analytics capabilities may serve more than one domain.

43
U.S. competitors screened

→

15
competitors marketing conversational AI

KEY TAKEAWAY

RWE has the highest concentration (9 of 34 competitors); trials and market access have one each.

An Optum LS offering would meet very different competition by domain.

In RWE, conversational AI now spans the workflow, from pre-sale data previews to analyses traditionally handled by specialists

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Identify and assess suitable data	Truven's **MarketScan Snapshot**: Natural-language assessment of MarketScan data suitability; Norstella's **Ella AI**: Conversational dataset recommendations (along with cohort construction and documented RWE analysis)	**Market Clarity Data** (linked claims/EHR); **Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-extracted clinical variables)
Explore patient populations and cohorts	Komodo Health's **Marmot** and **MapAI**: conversational healthcare analytics and cohort exploration; Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence**: natural-language research questions over longitudinal clinical data; Briya's **AIRE Population Agent** (Israel): natural-language cohort eligibility and feasibility assessment	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical models); **Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); **Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition analysis)
Investigate broader RWE questions	HealthVerity's **eXOs**: Conversational data feasibility, cohort design and auditable RWE analysis; BC Platforms' **BC Catalyst** (Finland): prompt-based cohort building and clinical/genomic research exploration	**Analytics on Demand** (statistical modeling, decision trees); epidemiology research services (advanced study methods, scientific review)

END-TO-END CONVERSATIONAL RWE

HealthVerity's eXOs and Norstella's Ella market conversational AI as a multi-step workflow, not just search. HealthVerity's eXOs advertises data feasibility, cohort design and RWE analysis, while Norstella's Ella offers dataset recommendations, cohort construction and analytics.

PRE-ENGAGEMENT DATA EVALUATION

Truven also uses its conversational AI as a sales tool, offering qualified prospects free MarketScan Snapshot access to cohort counts and summary statistics before they commit to a full RWE analysis.

In oncology and specialty data, vendors pitch conversational AI as a substitute for some routine analyst work

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Explore oncology and specialty cohorts	Flatiron Health's **Telescope**: conversational oncology cohort exploration; Tempus's **Lens**: clinical and molecular research exploration	**Enriched Clinical Data** (NLP-derived disease attributes); clinicogenomics datasets (linked clinical/genomic data)
Investigate specialty-disease evidence	ConcertAI's **Precision Explorer**: oncology research analytics; Verana Health's **Agent Claire**: conversational specialty-data research;	**Clinical Notes Lab** (NLP/LLMs, custom AI models); epidemiology and observational research (study design, comparative effectiveness)
Analyze curated research datasets	MDClone's **ADAMS Copilot** (Israel): conversational statistical analysis and visualization within controlled research datasets	**Analytics on Demand** (advanced statistical modeling, survival analysis); research data and study environments (curated data, analytical workspaces)

PACKAGED OUTCOMES STUDIES

ConcertAI markets named Precision Explorer agents for guideline concordance, real-world outcomes and comorbidity analysis; it claims projects can shrink "from 10-20 weeks to as little as 6 weeks."

SELF-SERVICE ANALYSIS

Specialty-data vendors market conversational AI as a way to supplant routine work by analysts: Flatiron's Telescope delivers survival analyses on demand, "eliminating the need to wait in analyst queues," while Verana's Agent Claire offers data access "without needing programming skills or analyst assistance."

In commercial intelligence, conversational AI reaches into reps' daily workflow and simulated market research

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical market and portfolio intelligence	IQVIA's **GMI Agent**: global market insights; GBI Health's **GBI BOT** (China): pharmaceutical database Q&A and competitive intelligence; Prospection's **ProGPT** (Australia): conversational patient and market insights for brand planning	**Market Clarity** (linked claims/EHR data, market attractiveness and portfolio analytics)
Commercial field and prescribing decisions	IQVIA's **Field Force Agent**: commercial field support; ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Commercial**: commercial information and decision support; Close-Up International's **Xplora AI** (Spain): AI-enabled pharmaceutical CRM and commercial intelligence	**Market Clarity** (patient/prescriber segmentation, treatment patterns, market analytics)
Simulated stakeholder research	Trinity Life Sciences' **InsightsEDGE Digital Twins**: conversational simulated personas; Ipsos's **Healthcare PersonaBot** (France): interaction with simulated healthcare stakeholders	**Market Clarity** (observed patient/prescriber insights); no comparable simulated-persona offering established

FROM INSIGHT TO FIELD ACTION

IQVIA's Field Force Agent uses CRM activity and call notes to recommend next best actions, with a claimed prep-time reduction of up to 27%. ZS's commercial assistant generates call plans and draft emails.

SYNTHETIC STAKEHOLDER RESEARCH

Trinity's data-grounded digital twins simulate HCP, patient and payer responses to test messages "without commissioning a new study every time"; Ipsos's PersonaBot hosts a "focus group" of personas drawn from clients' existing research.

In medical and regulatory work, conversational AI operates within tighter bounds, and one vendor publishes where it fails

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Search and synthesize scientific evidence	IQVIA's **Med-R1 Deep Research Agent**: synthesizes biomedical, clinical and regulatory sources to answer complex research questions	Epidemiology research (study design, RWE generation); postapproval safety and comparative-effectiveness studies (statistical analysis)
Explore medical insights and support scientific engagement	ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Medical**: natural-language analysis of care gaps, scientific insights and opinion-leader information; Evidenze's **AI medical-education chatbots** (Spain): conversational medical education and knowledge support	**Market Clarity** (medical affairs evidence, MSL insights, HCP analytics)
Question and navigate regulated documents	Veeva's **Vault AI Chat**: questions, summaries and follow-up interactions within authorized Vault documents and records	Safety and evidence-research services (scientific analysis); no comparable regulated-document assistant established

TRACKING MEDICAL AFFAIRS IMPACT

ZS positions its medical-affairs analytics as the answer to "what is medical affairs actually achieving?" The suite tracks care gaps in patient-level claims data and compares engaged and non-engaged populations over time; a conversational assistant lets teams query the results.

LIMITS IN THE OPEN

IQVIA says its small Med-R1 research agent can "outperform much larger general-purpose models," while conceding that multi-step biomedical reasoning remains unsolved. In its December 2025 benchmark, Med-R1 answered 21 of 50 questions—and none of the 10 hardest, where OpenAI's and Google's agents managed one between them.

Trials and market access have the fewest offerings, and one vendor already says chat answers aren't enough

CLINICAL TRIALS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Trial feasibility, site and investigator identification	TriNetX's **Terrain AI Assistant**: natural-language questions about trial sites, investigator experience and patient populations	**Prospector** (no-code cohort building, attrition funnels); **Digital Research Network** (patient identification, recruitment infrastructure)

MARKET ACCESS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM LS OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical pricing and market-access intelligence	EVERSANA's **Ask NAVLIN**: conversational access to pricing, reimbursement and market-access information	HEOR/value evidence (outcomes research, economic analysis); **Evidence Engine** (evidence-generation support); health economic and budget impact modeling (cost and budget scenarios)

WHICH SITES, NOT JUST HOW MANY

TriNetX is pushing trial feasibility from patient counts to site selection: it markets Terrain as surfacing "not just how many patients exist, but where they exist," and treats clinical trial payments data "as a real-world enrollment signal."

FROM ANSWERS TO WORKFLOWS

EVERSANA is moving market-access AI past chat answers. While offering Ask NAVLIN over pricing data from 100+ countries, it says "for important decisions, a good-looking AI answer is rarely enough" and is building early workflows where "sources and assumptions remain visible" for expert review.

ADDITIONAL COMPETITIVE DYNAMIC: LLM PROVIDERS EXPAND INTO LIFE SCIENCES

LLM providers now supply, build and buy their way into life sciences, making them potential partners and rivals

THREE OBSERVED APPROACHES TO ENTERING LIFE SCIENCES

LLM PROVIDER APPROACH	SELECTED PUBLIC DEVELOPMENTS	COMPETITIVE SIGNIFICANCE FOR OPTUM LS
Partner with established life-sciences vendors	**Anthropic + Komodo Health:** A documented partnership supporting AI-enabled healthcare analytics; **Anthropic + Veeva:** Claude incorporated into Veeva's industry-specific AI offerings; **AWS + Datavant:** Explore Assistant, publicly described in February 2026, uses Bedrock and AWS Clean Rooms to support natural-language assessment of healthcare datasets and research feasibility.	LLM providers supply the model while partners keep the data, applications and customer relationships; Komodo and Veeva already appear in this analysis.
Develop their own life-sciences-specific products and tools	**Anthropic's Claude for Life Sciences:** Specialized scientific tools and integrations supporting research, clinical trials and regulatory workflows; **OpenAI's GPT-Rosalind:** A purpose-built model for biology, drug discovery and translational research, with access expanded to eligible organizations in September 2026.	LLM providers are building products aimed directly at life-sciences users, reaching into workflows adjacent to Optum LS's RWE and healthcare-data offerings.
Acquire specialized life-sciences capabilities	**Cohere + Reliant AI:** In May 2026, Cohere acquired a biopharma AI company offering literature review, competitive landscaping and scientific/regulatory information extraction. The acquisition supports development of North for Pharma, a planned specialized agentic offering.	Acquisitions give LLM providers industry-specific technology, expertise and pharmaceutical customer relationships in one step.

PARTNER, SUPPLIER OR RIVAL

Anthropic already works with two competitors in this deck (Komodo and Veeva) while selling its own Claude for Life Sciences; Cohere bought its way in. For any Optum LS offering, the model provider may also be pursuing the same pharmaceutical customers.

KEY ASSUMPTIONS

Four assumptions shape this view, and each can be tested with internal evidence

ASSUMPTION	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW TO TEST IT (WHO HOLDS THE EVIDENCE)
Optum LS is developing or evaluating conversational access it doesn't yet market	If not, the four choices become a decision about whether to build at all, not design choices	Product roadmap (product, technology)
Conversational access influences what customers buy	It decides whether this is a revenue question or a feature question, and it's the basis for any dollar estimate	Win/loss notes, RFP requirements, pricing (commercial, finance); customer interviews
Vendor claims hold up in practice (27% prep time, 6-week studies)	These claims set the bar an Optum LS offering would be measured against	Customer references, independent tests (data and analytics). IQVIA's own benchmark shows the limits.
LLM providers remain suppliers more than rivals	Partnering for the model could create a future competitor	Partnership terms (strategy and enterprise development); see the LLM providers slide

METHODOLOGY

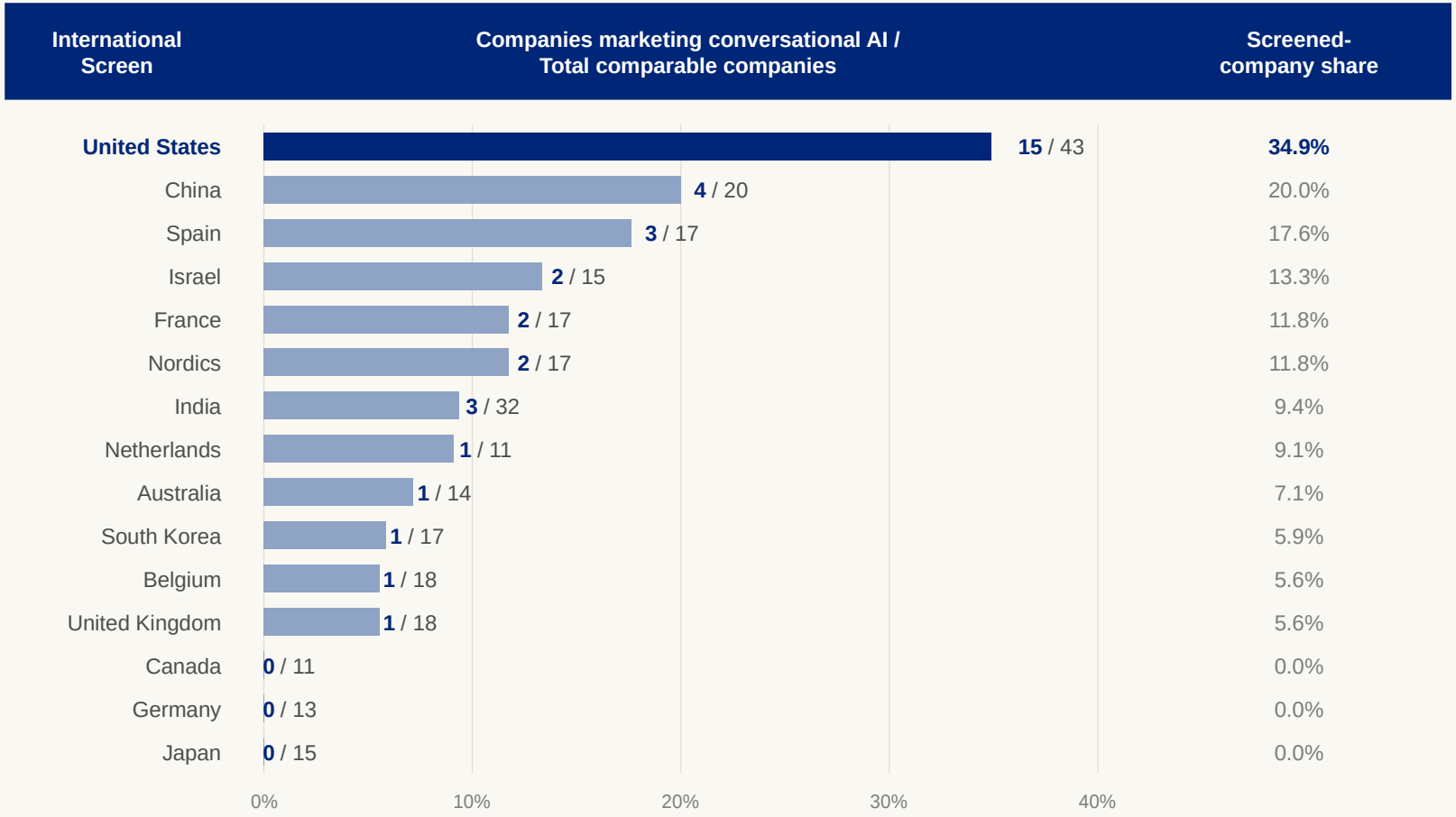
Findings reflect public positioning, not tested performance

1. SOURCES	Official vendor pages and announcements, reviewed through October 13, 2026.
2. DOMAINS	Five customer-task areas where Optum LS publicly markets offerings and competitors sell comparable ones. They classify the research; they are not Optum LS's own business categories.
3. QUALIFICATION	An offering qualified only if its public materials describe a conversational interface for a biopharma customer task; general AI or agentic claims did not.
4. COUNTS	43 U.S. competitor groups screened; 15 market 19 qualifying offerings. Domain counts overlap. Fourteen international screens add eight examples; their percentages aren't national adoption rates.
5. COMPARISON AND AI USE	Offerings were compared by customer task, not assumed to be equivalent. Vendor metrics are reported as claims. LLM-provider developments sit outside the counts. AI tools assisted the research and drafting.

APPENDIX: INTERNATIONAL COMPANY SCREENS

International screens add eight examples; none shows a higher screened share than the U.S.

COMPARABLE COMPANIES MARKETING CONVERSATIONAL AI



HOW TO READ THE COMPARISON

Each bar shows the share of screened comparable companies that market conversational AI. International counts exclude companies already represented in the U.S. inventory.